

money. We do not always have to follow someone else's interpretation of what it means to look after ourselves.

Suzy says 'I think we're all pretty well versed in mindfulness, but how do we actually make mindfulness feel juicy? Well, it's looking at specific applications of mindfulness. I think all of the skills are sort of a better use mindfulness. Maybe it's tapping into curiosity, maybe it's seeking a sense of wonder. It could be savouring where you suck the life out of pleasurable experiences, or you reminisce, or you anticipate future joys, it's bearing witness to connection. And, you know, that sense of shared humanity is in appreciation, and gratitude and kindness and compassion. So, I think if we can see at least part of our self-care as these things, none of those things cost a penny. When you become skilled at those things, that's when you start to feel less pushed around by life.'

And who doesn't want to feel that way? For many of us, that's what we're seeking when we cast about ourselves for self-care – the feeling of being less pushed around by life, of claiming something for ourselves, on our own terms.

In order to discover what it really means to properly look after ourselves, we need to take things right back to the Maslow hierarchy, and work our way up from the base level to the top, making sure that we are satisfying our own individual basic needs before we go in search of more superficial self-care solutions. Then we'll be able to value those experiences that we do decide to invest our hard-earned cash in. Think about